

Interviewer: [00:00:06] Good afternoon, thank you again for participating in this interview. As I mentioned in the message, we would like to know more about your views on romantic relationships. I believe that your experiences and your perspective will contribute a lot to the project. Is it okay if I record this interview before we start? I will only use this recording for transcription notes.

Speaker: [00:00:26] Yeah, no problem.

Interviewer: [00:00:28] Okay, thank you. First of all, how old are you?

Speaker: [00:00:33] [46-50].

Interviewer: [00:00:35] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: [00:00:40] About [16-20].

Interviewer: [00:00:44] [16-20] years?

Speaker: [00:00:45] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:00:48] Do you have children?

Speaker: [00:00:50] [1-5] tane.

Interviewer: [00:00:53] Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: [00:00:56] My wife, [1-5] children.

Interviewer: [00:00:59] [1-5] people.

Speaker: [00:01:00] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:01:01] What is your main source of income? What is your current job?

Speaker: [00:01:04] I'm a [Job Title].

Interviewer: [00:01:08] How would you like me to address your partner? Your girlfriend, your wife, your wife, your lover and so on.

Speaker: [00:01:16] So by name also I'm not myself, are you?

Interviewer: [00:01:20] Yes, how should I address your wife?

Speaker: [00:01:23] No problem.

Interviewer: [00:01:24] To your partner

Speaker: [00:01:25] No problem, so whatever you see fit.

Interviewer: [00:01:26] Shall I continue as your wife then?

Speaker: [00:01:29] It happens, it happens. No problem.

Interviewer: [00:01:31] Can you tell me how you and your partner met, how your relationship started?

Speaker: [00:01:36] We don't have such a story of meeting. It is an arranged marriage through the sisters.

Interviewer: [00:01:43] Uh-huh.

Speaker: [00:01:44] I mean, we met, we went, we came, we saw, that's how it happened.

Interviewer: [00:01:47] When did you meet?

Speaker: [00:01:50] That's a good question. I don't have such a memory, a good memory. So [16-20] years ago, we met through sisters. I mean, we didn't go with much enthusiasm, but it happened. How it happened, it happened.

Interviewer: [00:02:10] So how did your relationship develop? How did it start?

Speaker: [00:02:13] We went, we saw one of them.. That's how it developed.

Interviewer: [00:02:20] So how would you rate the quality of your own relationship compared to the relationships of your friends, people around you?

Speaker: : [00:02:30] So the quality of my own relationship, what my friends say are very different. I mean, my relationship is a little bit different, a lot of my friends' relationships are also different.

Interviewer: : [00:02:41] So how? Why do you say that, can you explain that a little bit more?

Speaker: [00:02:47] For example, there are many people around who have not developed themselves. For example, there are many people who don't know how to treat their families, how to treat their children. What should I say, how should I say it?

Interviewer: [00:03:17] So can I ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: [00:03:22] Very.

Interviewer: [00:03:24] If you want to give a number, if you remember.

Speaker: [00:03:27] So what should I say, you're asking about the youth thing?

Interviewer: [00:03:30] Uh-huh Exactly, in the past.

Speaker: [00:03:31] Maybe 50, maybe 100.

Interviewer: [00:03:36] So how would you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous relationships?

Speaker: [00:03:41] The previous relationship is very different because there was no marriage. But now when there is marriage, it is very different because there are things that require responsibility, family responsibilities.

Interviewer: [00:03:55] Can you explain a little bit why you say that, why do you think that?

Speaker: [00:04:00] Well, at that time, in the youth, let's call it a young mind. I mean you don't think, I mean you don't take responsibility, you don't have a logic that you will get married. I mean it's just a temporary thing, it's just temporary. You're just fooling around, nothing else.

Interviewer: [00:04:17] So, for you, what makes a relationship high-quality, what makes it qualified?

Speaker: [00:04:24] Mutual compatibility.

Interviewer: [00:04:28] So, what makes it low quality?

Speaker: [00:04:32] What makes it low quality? You already know people, so you see how far you can go with them. After you see, I mean, you feel that you can do something mutually or you can't do something mutually.

Interviewer: [00:04:49] So, reciprocity, why do you think so first of all? You said mutual compatibility, can you explain a little bit why you think this way?

Speaker: [00:04:57] I mean, you can't share everything with everyone, for example. The other person can be manipulative, they can think different things. I mean, they don't necessarily think of something forward-looking with you. They can also think of something temporary.

Interviewer: [00:05:15] You said that high quality relationships are mutual compatibility.

You said it would happen if this was ensured.

Speaker: [00:05:21] So, I mean, brain numbing.

Interviewer: [00:05:25] So, close relationships, you know, brain matching, would you say that's a strong relationship?

Speaker: [00:05:32] Yes, I would

Interviewer: [00:05:36] So, how do you know that a person is mutually compatible with you, that you're in a relationship where you're mutually compatible, that you're in this relationship?

Speaker: [00:05:46] How do I know? I mean, it is such a thing that it is developing. Inevitably it is already forming. How can I tell you? I mean, you meet, you move forward. Time already manages it in your own way.

Interviewer: [00:06:07] So, when would you say that your relationship is mutually compatible?

Speaker: [00:06:14] You mean the maturation period?

Interviewer: [00:06:17] You said, for example, you said mutual brain match, mutual compatibility. When is the moment when your relationship is in sync for you? When is the moment when it is at least in sync?

Speaker: [00:06:28] Now in the past we didn't think of such a numbing thing. I mean, as a brain, it used to be the whims of youth, how should I put it, temporary things, I mean, it was happening. But now it's marriage, in marriage, I mean, there is such a thing as not doing wrong or something like that, how can I tell you. There are realities of life, you have to adapt to those realities.

Interviewer: [00:06:56] So, for you, when was the least time there was a mismatch in this relationship?

Speaker: [00:07:04] On the marriage thing?

Interviewer: [00:07:05] Uh-huh.

Speaker: [00:07:06] There was no moment of mismatch, so it happened the way I wanted it to happen when I wanted it to happen.

Interviewer: [00:07:12] So, what are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker: [00:07:17] Respect, mutual respect. I mean, not lying to each other, that is, the loyalty and honesty of the family members to each other. There is one thing I say to my wife "if you do anything outside or inside, don't lie, I mean, tell the truth, tell me the truth." As long as I know, the rest is not important.

Interviewer: [00:07:45] So, why do you think that, why did you say that? Can you explain a little bit?

Speaker: [00:07:49] Now when you speak a lie in life, the rest comes. It comes constantly, and this time you have no chance to trust the other person in any way. When a lie is told, it is like telling a lie for a lifetime. That's how I see it. Just as I want that from the other person, I struggle not to do that. Then there is sincerity.

Interviewer: [00:08:12] So, for you, what is love (aşk) to you?

Speaker: [00:08:16] To us, love (aşk) is something that comes and goes.

Interviewer: [00:08:20] For you?

Speaker: [00:08:20] So there is respect. Love is something that lasts for [1-5] month, [1-5] months.

Interviewer: [00:08:32] So, that [1-5] month thing, you know, for you, what is love to you?

Speaker: [00:08:38] Love for me is not a very different thing. Love is something that comes and goes for me.

Interviewer: [00:08:45] So, how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: [00:08:51] Well, not really. It's not that much, it's not that important.

Interviewer: [00:09:00] How do you know if your partner loves you?

Speaker: [00:09:02] I understand from her behavior.

Interviewer: [00:09:08] What else?

Speaker: [00:09:10] You can tell by the way she behaves, the way she talks, the way she approaches, the way she gets close, everything.

Interviewer: [00:09:18] So, what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: [00:09:24] I haven't had many difficulties in my relationship. I mean, it's been going on for [11-15] - [16-20] years just like we know it. I don't have a relationship where I have such difficulty.

Interviewer: [00:09:35] So, do you and your partner fight?

Speaker: [00:09:39] Usually I am a little bit. If she says something to me, I shut up, if I say something, she shuts up. We don't fight reciprocally in any way. That's why the fight doesn't last. It doesn't last much.

Interviewer: [00:09:54] So, can you tell us how often these fights and arguments happened?

Speaker: [00:10:00] Not often, actually. I mean, there is no such frequency. How should I put it, it's usually because of the children, for example. When she yells at the children, when my wife yells at them, when I do something, when I sometimes say that why you are going so far. It usually happens this way because of the children.

Interviewer: [00:10:18] So, how do you resolve these fights?

Speaker: [00:10:22] It resolves itself. When she stops talking or when I don't say anything, it resolves itself. It's not a fight actually. It's a bit of a marriage thing, how do you say? It happens in marriage. I mean, that kind of thing happens.

Interviewer: [00:10:45] Well, for example, you said I shut up or she shuts up. Apart from shutting up, what are the other ways of maintaining your relationship, of solving these fights, other ways?

Speaker: [00:10:57] What are the other ways? Explaining to her whether she is right or wrong.

Interviewer: [00:11:06] Uh-huh.

Speaker: [00:11:07] So if I'm right, when I know that the other person is not going to understand, I usually shut up, but if I know that I can express it, I express it, and that's how we get along.

Interviewer: [00:11:21] Would you say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: [00:11:25] I would. I would tell based on my experiences.

Interviewer: [00:11:30] Why is it, you know, can you explain that a little bit? Why is this relationship a good relationship for you?

Speaker: [00:11:36] We have had years of good relationship. We have no problems right now, thank God. I mean, it lasts because the other person is understanding, so it has to last.

Interviewer: [00:11:53] Can you give some more concrete examples?

Speaker: [00:11:55] What example can I give you?

Interviewer: [00:12:00] From your daily life.

Speaker: [00:12:02] We share everything, we share joy, or if something develops in our life, for example, the smallest thing, we share them with each other. If something happens to our children, we share them. I mean, there is nothing much concrete, so life goes on somehow.

Interviewer: [00:12:28] So did this relationship change you?

Speaker: [00:12:32] No, I am what I was.

Interviewer: [00:12:35] And did your partner change during that relationship?

Speaker: [00:12:39] My partner hasn't changed either. She's going the way I knew her.

Interviewer: [00:12:42] So, for example, is the person you were before the relationship the same person you are now?

Speaker: [00:12:49] Same person.

Interviewer: [00:12:51] Your partner too?

Speaker: [00:12:53] She's the same same person, but life changes things. I mean it changes your views.

Interviewer: [00:13:00] So can you elaborate on that a little bit?

Speaker: [00:13:02] I mean, when you have children, you have different responsibilities. For example, in the past, you used to go traveling, you used to go around, you used to spend money, you used to do whatever. Now you don't do these things. For example, you don't go and do the things you used to spend on yourself. You think that you can do them for your children.

Interviewer: [00:13:26] Uh-huh.

Speaker: [00:13:28] So life is a little bit more responsible.

Interviewer: [00:13:35] Yes. Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker: [00:13:39] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:13:41] Can you explain why you say that?

Speaker: [00:13:4] So I trust my wife. There is no reason, so trust.

Interviewer: [00:13:54] Yes. Is there a concrete example you can give?

Speaker: [00:13:59] What I can give concretely is a person that I can come and find in my house whenever I want, in any way I want, in a comfortable way. So I don't have to think about this behind my back. I don't wonder if she won't be home when I get home. Actually, it's different. You set certain rules in your home. As long as you live by those rules, you don't have any problems as long as they don't cross your lines.

Interviewer: [00:14:28] Yes. Now I'm going to ask you a question, it's a scale, but I'll show it here so you can understand it. If I ask you if my partner usually really listens to me. There are numbers from one to nine on a scale of one not at all true to nine completely true. Which one would you choose? What would be your answer?

Speaker: [00:14:49] So she'll listen to me until nine

Interviewer: [00:14:53] If you were to say a number, one, two, three, four, four, five, six, seven, eight, nine.

Speaker: [00:14:58] I say nine.

Interviewer: [00:15:02] So can I know why you answered nine?

Speaker: [00:15:06] Well, everything I say

Interviewer: [00:15:07] Why nine and not eight?

Speaker: [00:15:10] So she trusts, believes and relies on everything I say. I am like that with her

Interviewer: [00:15:18] Can you tell me when these things happened?

Speaker: [00:15:24] Everytime when I say something

Interviewer: [00:15:25] Can you give me an example of a time when you say she listens to me?

Speaker: [00:15:30] For example, between us, something like this does not develop, I mean, you come home, you sit at home, you sit well, you drink, you eat, I mean, your life continues as a routine in a way. But I mean, there is not necessarily a problem-free life, but we don't have an exaggerated problem. I mean, I'm comfortable. Let me say that she is comfortable and I am comfortable.

Interviewer: [00:16:03] Well, and I'll show you this, my partner is usually sensitive to my needs. Again there are numbers from one to nine.

Speaker: [00:16:18] So everything I've asked for happened so far. So I would say nine that too.

Interviewer: [00:16:30] Uh-huh. Can you give an example of that? An example of a moment when you say it is sensitive to your needs.

Speaker: [00:16:38] So my wife actually understands my needs. For example, she buys my clothes. I'm not a person who buys things easily, for example.

Speaker: [00:16:48] So she completes me. She dresses. So she understands me.

Interviewer: [00:16:55] Well I hope you don't mind me asking and if this is too sensitive for you to share please feel free to say so. But I would like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker: [00:17:12] So it could be two times a week. It could be three times.

Speaker: [00:17:16] So it's fine.

Interviewer: [00:17:18] And how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: [00:17:22] How satisfied are we with our sex life?

Interviewer: [00:17:25] You, just you.

Speaker: [00:17:27] I'm satisfied, I'm fine with it. It's just a fact of life.

Interviewer: [00:17:33] So do you want to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that? Why do you think that?

Speaker: [00:17:39] I mean, there is nothing that I want to do that I can't do right now. I don't have a thought. When I want, for example, if I want that, it happens. I mean, the other person wants it too.

Interviewer: [00:17:53] When I asked you what are the important things in a relationship for you, you didn't include sexuality.

Speaker: [00:18:00] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:18:01] Can I ask you why you think it's important or not?

Speaker: [00:18:05] Sexuality usually comes last. I mean, sexuality doesn't dominate family matters that much. Of course, it happens, but it is not something that comes to the forefront that much.

Interviewer: [00:18:22] Uh-huh.

Speaker: [00:18:22] Family things are a bit different for me.

Interviewer: [00:18:25] I'm going to show you a scale again, how satisfied are you with your relationship in general? Completely dissatisfied, very dissatisfied, somewhat dissatisfied, not sure/undecided, somewhat satisfied. Very satisfied. Completely satisfied.

Speaker: [00:18:44] So I'm completely satisfied. There is also this fact of life.

Speaker: [00:18:50] Now, because of what I have experienced before, I have received some pleasures, some things, so what I'm experiencing now is not very extreme feelings. So I'm satisfied.

Speaker: [00:19:03] Also, as you get older, you push certain things into the background, inevitably.

Interviewer: [00:19:12] You answered that you are completely satisfied with your relationship.

Speaker: [00:19:14] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:19:15] So I'll show you one more scale for that. 0 is not satisfied at all. 10 completely satisfied, which one would you choose 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10?

Speaker: [00:19:26] 10 I am completely satisfied.

Interviewer: [00:19:29] So why did you answer 10? You know, why 10 and not 9?

Speaker: [00:19:33] So I don't have any different desires. I am satisfied with my life. I am also satisfied with my wife. I mean, I am not a person who has any desire for anything outside. It may be because of my youth or something coming from that, but I don't have any dissatisfaction.

Interviewer: [00:20:00] So did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker: [00:20:04] It did. It wouldn't have lasted anyway if it didn't.

Interviewer: [00:20:12] We are about to finish. I would like to summarize what we talked about for the last half an hour. You said that you are generally satisfied with your relationship. There is a little bit of time in between sometimes because of the children but you said that they are not arguments.

Speaker: [00:20:25] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:20:25] You said the most important thing in a relationship is respect.

Speaker: [00:20:28] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:20:29] Love is not very important. You said respect, mutual love, compatibility.

Speaker: [00:20:32] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:20:33] You said that my wife is sensitive to my needs. You said she understands me even if I don't say it.

Speaker: [00:20:38] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:20:39] Were they true?

Speaker: [00:20:41] That is correct.

Interviewer: [00:20:43] Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker: [00:20:45] No, brother.

Interviewer: [00:20:46] Anything else?

Speaker: [00:20:48] No, I mean, what I want to add is that people in life are mutual, how should I say, the most important thing in a marriage, that is, in order to have a mutual loyalty, not to lie, that is, the family members should not lie to each other in any way whatsoever. If my wife tells me a lie once, I would not trust her for the rest of my life, in my logic, my thoughts, for the rest of my life. A single lie, even if it is within the family or in any other way, she has to speak the truth. That's my logic. That's my brain.

Interviewer: [00:21:27] Thank you very much.

Speaker: [00:21:30] You're welcome

Interviewer: [00:21:30] Now before we finish I would like to talk to you about how we will handle the data. As a research project we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. Therefore, I would like to know which data sharing option is the most suitable for you. I will now give you two options. You will choose the one that suits you. The first option is to share some parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain anyone who can identify you. So that our de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers.

Speaker: [00:22:02] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:22:04] The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a little bit bolder, is to share the full transcript of our interview, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, that is, anonymized.

Speaker: [00:22:18] No you can share. Second option.

Interviewer: [00:22:20] In this option there is a slim, slim chance that someone who knows you well will be able to piece together the details from the interview transcript and narrow down the choices as to who they believe you are among the professional gems. Again, I want to emphasize that no sensitive information will be shared.

Speaker: [00:22:35] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:22:36] Which of the two options do you prefer?

Speaker: [00:22:38] The second option is also okay, brother.

Interviewer: [00:22:42] Okay thank you.

Speaker: [00:22:43] You're welcome.

Interviewer: [00:22:44] Thank you very much for participating in this study. I want you to know that this study has also been done in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France and the USA. For this study to be a success, there is one more thing I would like to ask of you, if it's okay with you. Can you suggest two close people in our lives as candidates? I will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this study. I will not meet the people you suggest, I will call the people you suggest and ask them for people to meet. I will also ask them for couples that you don't know and can't find. This way we can reach as diverse a group of participants as possible. Is that okay with you?

Speaker: [00:23:20] That is not suitable for me. If you say why; When I give people something like this, most people unconsciously think why are you giving, why are you giving, why are you giving, and so on and so forth. That's why I don't want to give in this way, brother.

Interviewer: [00:23:38] Okay. Thank you very much. Again for participating.

Speaker: [00:23:40] You're welcome.

Interviewer: [00:23:41] I am ending the recording of these videos

Speaker: [00:23:43] See you soon.